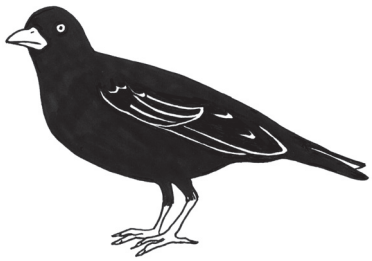
Sexual selection



Bowerbirds live in northern Australia and throughout Papua New Guinea. They are **polygamous**, which means they have more than one mate, and have unique **courtship** behaviour.

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete these sentences about the courtship behaviour of bowerbirds.

Word bank							
sticks	best	attract	bower	coloured	many	steal	males

- Males build a structure called a b_____.
- They decorate the **bower** with s_____ and brightly c_____ objects.
- Bowers a_____ females.
- Females visit m_____ bowers.
- Males sometimes s_____ objects from one another's bowers.
- Females mate with m_____ that make the b____ bowers.

The male bowerbirds that make the most elaborate bowers are able to pass on their genetic material. This is called sexual selection, because the females select partners based on an ability, quality or strength.

☞ **2** Separate the words below to make sentences.

Malefrogsattractfemaleswiththeirloudcalls.

_____

Malelyrebirdsattractfemalesbydisplayingtheirlargetails.

_____

Malewildhorsesfightwitheachothertoleadtheherd.

_____

Theherdleaderistheonlymaletomatewithallthefemales.

_____

3 Select the most successful males in the following animal groups.

Aggressive stallion	Passive stallion
Quiet frog	Loud frog
Non-thieving bowerbird	Thieving bowerbird
Lyrebird with a small tail	Lyrebird with a big tail

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